ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Scholarships, Grants and Financial Aid: Apply Without Wasting Money

Find legitimate opportunities, prepare documents early and write a strong application

MONEY & CAREER

Money & Career

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Study smarter. Ask better questions. Pass with understanding.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Scholarship information is scattered and often surrounded by fraud. This pack explains where legitimate opportunities are announced, how to prepare a reusable document pack, how to write a personal statement that does not sound generic, and how to recognise fake portals.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Identify credible sources of scholarship and grant information.
- Prepare a reusable application document pack.
- Write a specific personal statement and request references properly.
- Recognise and avoid scholarship scams.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Where legitimate opportunities live

Reliable information comes from institutions, not from forwarded messages.

- University scholarship offices, faculty notice boards and official websites.
- Federal and state scholarship boards, and their verified portals.
- Corporate foundations and professional bodies in Nigeria.
- Embassy and international development programmes.
- Departmental and alumni awards, which are often under-applied for.
- Verify every opportunity on an official domain before submitting anything.

Prepare once, apply many times

Most applications ask for the same material. Build a pack.

- Academic transcripts or results, admission letter and student ID.
- A current CV of one page.
- A personal statement of 500 to 800 words that you can adapt.
- Two academic references with up-to-date contact details.
- Passport photographs in the required specification.
- Certificates and evidence of leadership or volunteering.

> **Legitimate schemes do not ask for payment**
> Application fees and 'processing charges' from unknown portals are a warning sign. Confirm with the institution before paying anything.

Write it specifically

Reviewers read many similar statements. Specificity is your advantage.

1. Open with a concrete moment that explains your direction, not a quotation.
2. State your course and the problem you want to work on.
3. Give evidence: results, projects, responsibilities, measurable outcomes.
4. Explain why this specific scheme, not any scholarship.
5. Describe what you will do afterwards in concrete terms.
6. Edit for length, clarity and one consistent tense.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Name three credible sources of scholarship information.

Answer: The university scholarship office, federal or state scholarship boards, and verified corporate foundation websites.

2. What is a warning sign of a scholarship scam?

Answer: A request for an application or processing fee, especially through a personal account or unofficial link.

3. What should a personal statement avoid?

Answer: Generic quotations, vague claims about being hardworking, and text that could apply to any applicant or scholarship.

4. How should you request a reference?

Answer: Ask in advance, in person or by a clear message, provide your CV and the deadline, and follow up politely.

5. Why build a reusable document pack?

Answer: It reduces the time per application and prevents missing documents when a deadline is short.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Write down five credible scholarship sources to monitor.
- [ ] Assemble your document pack in one folder.
- [ ] Draft a 600-word personal statement.
- [ ] Ask two referees and confirm their contact details.
- [ ] Prepare a one-page CV.
- [ ] Verify one opportunity through an official channel.
- [ ] Apply to at least one scheme this semester.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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